

A2DP. The BT-5020 was also on display for Rs 3,600. This unit supports pairing with two devices, useful for those who use more than one cellphone. It's a good choice for someone looking for a feature rich handsfree unit but once again I felt the earpiece was a little too hard and uncomfortable. The Plantronics Discovery-925 was a super sexy BT handsfree that stood out because of its unique looks. The earpiece itself is quite small while the mouthpiece is designed as a slim extension. Priced at Rs 6,700 it allows connections with two BT devices and comes with three sizes of ear tips. This would be my choice if I were shopping for a quality handsfree unit to use with both my cellphones.

Some cellphone users do a lot of emailing and also work with a lot of documents. Most cellphones other than the PDA-based BlackBerry and WM based devices (that have full QWERTY keypads) are not meant typing out more than a long SMS and are therefore not ideal for typing longer emails and such. If you are one such user you may need a full QWERTY keypad. And I'm not talking about full-size desktop keyboards that are impossible to cart around. Sadly there are very few options when it comes to compact QWERTY keypads – it seems people hardly buy them and prefer to send mails with their cramped cellphone keypads. I came across a couple of options. One was this compact keyboard of Chinese origin. Priced at Rs 3,500 this keyboard has

small but well laid out keys with good key spacing. Unfortunately feedback is not intuitive and overall it takes time to get used to the smaller keys, especially if you are familiar with desktop and notebook PC keyboards. The next device I came across was very neat. Priced at an astronomical Rs 10,000 I would definitely not buy one myself but the idea is novel and neat. It's a Bluetooth device that can project a virtual keyboard on any solid, non-transparent surface. This is a superb choice for someone who has a high-end PDA phone and wants a near-to-full-size keyboard to use with it. I tried the device, it worked

flawlessly with my N95 8 GB and although its overkill for SMSing, its wonderful for typing out long emails.

I was also looking for protection cases and covers. Jewel cases are available from Rs 50 bucks onward and you can pick one up from street side vendors. Better quality cases available in Croma and Reliance Digital will set you back by up to Rs 500 but will last longer. They also do not have the problem of the plastic getting scuffed and scratched thereby giving a very dirty, translucent appearance. Soft silicone covers are also available and while some people think them ugly, nobody can deny these protect your valuable

handset in case of a drop. Silicone covers are available for different phone models and in different colours and are priced at anywhere between Rs 60 and Rs 400. The better quality cases weather better, I've had bad experiences with some of the cheaper local ones where the silicone becomes gooey in the monsoons and it sticks to the insides of the pocket not to mention on the body of the phone. If you have a touchscreen phone or even a non-touchscreen phone with a large display you may want

to protect the screen with a screen protector as well. Screen guards are also available and depending on you're the screen size the price varies between Rs 50 and Rs 150.

However, there are a couple of good brands available in places like Croma and priced at Rs 350 or so for an N95 8 GB they make good sense since the top shiny surface does not fleck after a few months of heavy use like it does with ordinary screen guards.

I also saw a couple of Zagg screen guards for the iPhone and iPod Touch. These are the best your money can buy and really have a clear, shiny surface and the clarity is as good as not having anything on your screen. Priced at Rs 900, I would definitely buy this for my iPod Touch and plan on doing so when my current scratch guard is wasted.

One of the easiest things to buy for your cellphone is memory. Flash memory is dirt-cheap at the moment and regardless of the form factor of memory utilised by your phone you'll find something cheap. I suggest buying the largest possible capacity. If your phone supports it invest in an 8 GB or a 16 GB card. Expect to pay around Rs 950 on average for an 8 GB card while a 16 GB card will cost you around Rs 1,800. Sony's MS Pro/Pro Duo cards are expensive however and the premium you pay for using this memory can be as high as 200%. There are also cheap Li-ion battery rechargers available – very useful for those having more than one battery. Such chargers are priced at Rs 150 – 250 and work for a variety of Li-ion batteries. The only issue is reliability and I've found that one needs to be a little lucky when buying one of these.

I also came across some speakers built for cellphones. Sold by brands like Nokia and Sony Ericsson as accessories to extend the volume range of your cellphones puny loudspeaker especially when listening to music. The Sony Ericsson MPS-70 is priced at Rs 1,500 and is a pretty sweet deal. They offer acceptable sound quality for the price and are compact enough to be carried in a pouch. Nokia's MD-6 was also available. This speaker system is pretty neat and at first glance looks like the body of a torch. The two speakers are joint by a hinge, when opened you can see the two speakers sitting against each other. **[1]**



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